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Travel Radio Australia and we're here at a fantastic international golf event in Caen on the French Riviera and I've run into Alfred Smolik who's from Management Life Television in Austria. Alfred, welcome to the program. Thank you very much, pleasure meeting you.

Now Alfred, you're an Austrian based travel writer, journalist with Management Life TV. Tell us how did you get started in this whole industry? To be honest Jeff, it was by accident because when I started playing golf about, let me say, 20 years ago, I made some pictures. I traveled around to Italy, to Spain because I'm based in Austria so that means Italy and Spain is very close to me.

Beautiful golf destinations. I played there and made holidays there and made some pictures. A friend of mine, he said one day, why don't you show the pictures? Why don't you make film reports about the destinations? Because I always said it's so beautiful, the golf courses, the surroundings, the people and the culture and everything and that was my start.

I considered and said, oh it's a good idea, why not? I had nothing to do with filming before in my life but then I started on my own and improved myself in that and now I think since 15 years I make these film reports. Now it's Management Life TV which you can find online very very easily. You can just google that and it's straight.

We'll get to the website at the end but tell us about Management Life TV. How does that work? It works very easy. The name Management Life comes from the two parts management and life.

In former times I had a company, event agency let me say and we had business events and we had also events for children and for families and this was the reason to call it Management and Life and now it's only Management Life in one word. The last years I focused just on the tourism part for the film reports, mainly golf but also all kinds of tourism. Now our Australian listeners love Austria as a destination and hundreds of thousands of Australians have visited.

Tell us about your region in Austria and tell us a bit about it. I live in the region of Salzburg. It's, let me say, close to the border to Italy, between Italy and Germany and Salzburg is a Mozart town, Wolfgang Amadeus, the famous musician.

The region where I live, countryside and we have also many tourists because we have the city, we have a beautiful city of Salzburg. We have a lot of culture and we have also some lakes and you, we can, we have ski resorts very close. That means I live in a beautiful touristic region but I prefer to go outside.

Unfortunately never, I've never been to Australia. Oh you must come because Australia is fantastic and especially in our, in our ski resorts in Australia and we, we do have nine. I was very good friends with an Austrian guy called Hans Grimace who started one of the top pensions.

He was from Austria at Mount Buller, one of our regions. Speaking about Salzburg, I have actually been there and the Christmas market is absolutely brilliant there. I've been to the Christmas market.

Yes, definitely it's a highlight, a yearly highlight. The Christmas market, it's close to the, to the dome in the heart of the city. People are coming from everywhere only to see this market and many people are also coming for celebrating New Year and it's very close.

I mean the Christmas market from let me say November, December celebrating New Year. Many people from everywhere, China, Italy, of course Australians as well but when you mentioned Austria as a ski destination, I was working as a ski instructor in the former times here and we had also Australian ski instructors. It was very funny working with them together.

Oh yes because the Austrians as soon as it hits your summer, they all travel down to Australia for our winter which starts in June and there's a huge amount of Austrian ski instructors on our mountains which is Mount Buller, Force Creek, Parrish, Thredbo and and it's it's a massive exchange program. Now tell us about, you're a golf specialist journalist and tell us about your life in that area. As a golf travel journalist, I was very lucky the last 15 years because I saw many countries, I saw many golf resorts, golf courses, hotels and so on.

People always asking what is the most exciting golf destination you ever been. It's hard to answer this question but if I should say something Japan for me is very unique, it's very unique area. They have 2,000 more than 2,000 golf courses and the golf courses are brilliant maintenance but on the other hand four weeks ago, end of September, I have been to El Gouna, Egypt and they have artificial made Laguna and with a lot of hotels, brilliant hotels, restaurants and two golf courses, very beautiful.

I mean what I want to say, I'm sure also in Australia are beautiful courses. I think it's a gold coast, the gold coast where you have Sanctuary Cove which is one of the greatest golf courses in the world. To answer your question, yes I travel a lot year by year.

It's very interesting to show our clients on Management Live TV what possibilities in golf tourism is available and it's very competitive of course and within Europe we have 8,000 to 9,000 golf courses. It's not possible to visit every golf course or every region but I think our clients they have a huge choice and the IGTM here of course it's a meeting point for everybody, for suppliers, for buyers and for their media as well. Yes, it's a wonderful conference here.

The people from all the golf courses from across the world and hotels and luxury hotels connected to them all get here for IGTM, International Golf Travel Market. It's a great event and how can people find out more about Management Live TV? We're speaking with Alfred Smolik who's the journalist for Management Live Television in Austria. How can people find out more online? It's very easy.

You visit our website www.managementlive.tv or the short form is MLTV.at because we are based in Austria. Visit the site and you will find a lot of reports mainly about golf in the whole world. Just one more thing.

I always ask this. Tell us about one or two of your fantastic hidden gem destinations in Austria. If Australians are visiting Austria, where should they go that maybe is a little bit off the beaten track and very special? It depends what you prefer.

You prefer nature, you prefer lakeside, you prefer mountainside, you prefer summer or winter. It really depends on beautiful places of course. Let me start with city tourism.

It's Vienna and Salzburg. These are the most beautiful cities in Austria. I hope no Austrian guy will hear this interview.

Where you will find a lot of nature is in a so-called lower Austria region. It's east of Austria. It's called the Waldviertel.

Difficult name for you I guess. But if you find nature around there. And on the other side, on the western side of Austria, of course you have Tyrol, you have the mountain sides and also in Salzburg we have the mountains.

I think when you come from Australia you should go from the east to the west of Austria, from the mountains to the sea. Gorgeous. Well thank you so much Alfred Smolik from Management Life TV.

Look them up on online from Austria. Thanks very much for being on the program. Thank you so much and kind regards from Austria to Australia.

We don't have kangaroos. And tschüss.